

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦ K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠ J

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 2 ♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣ 10

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠ 9

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠ Q

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ 8 7 4
♦ Q J 10 8 6
♣ A 10 4

♠ A Q J 9 7 6 5

♥ Q 10 2

♦ 7

♣ 6 3



♠ 8 2
♥ A 9 6 3
♦ A K 5 3
♣ 9 8 5

♠ K 4

♥ K J 5

♦ 9 4 2

♣ K Q J 7 2

NORTH has a 7-card ♠ suit but he is too strong to open with a preemptive bid. So he opens 1 ♠ instead.

SOUTH should respond 2 ♣, and NORTH can do nothing but rebid the ♠ suit.

SOUTH thinks there should be game and bids 4 ♠

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ K			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q
♥ Q J
♦ A K Q 6 5
♣ K J 4 2

♠ A 8
♥ 10 6 5
♦ J 10 8
♣ 10 9 8 7 3

	N	
W		E
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♠ 7 6 4
♥ A K 9 7 4 3
♦ 7 2
♣ Q 5

♠ J 10 9 5 3 2
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ A 6

EAST is too weak to open 1♥ but just right for 2♥.

Wow! WEST has 21 HCP and two good ♥s. Could this be time for a slam try?

Nope, no slam here. Suppose EAST has six ♥s headed by the AK. The trump suit would certainly be solid, but then EAST couldn't possibly have an outside Ace as well or he would have been too strong for a Weak-two opening. So WEST just bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
		2♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			
4♥ by East			
Lead: ♠J			

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 10 9 8 3
♦ A 10 3
♣ 10 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ 4

♦ K Q 9 4

♣ K J 7 4 2



♠ K 6 4 2

♥ 5

♦ J 7 6 2

♣ A Q 9 6

♠ J 8 3

♥ K Q J 7 6 2

♦ 8 5

♣ 8 5

NORTH really hates that 2♥ opening by SOUTH.

But there's no sense bidding and probably making matters worse, so she grits her teeth and passes.

If you think 3NT has a chance you are delusional.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by South

Lead: ♣10

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 10 6 5

♥ 7

♦ A 9 5

♣ K J 3

♠ 9

♥ J 9 3

♦ Q J 7 3

♣ A Q 10 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 4

♥ A Q 10 6 4 2

♦ 4

♣ 9 6 5

♠ 7 3 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ K 10 8 6 2

♣ 7 2

WEST expects to be better off in ♠s than EAST would be in 2♥.

Whether or not you play a new suit as a one round force or not, EAST should make the 3♠ bid with a hand this good. WEST then bids the ♠ game.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♠9

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 4 2
♥ 2
♦ 10 9 7
♣ Q 9 6 5 3 2

♠ 6

♥ A Q J 8 7 5 4

♦ 6 3 2

♣ 8 4



♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ 10 9

♦ A 8

♣ K J 10 7

♠ A K 7 5

♥ K 6 3

♦ K Q J 5 4

♣ A

NORTH has a pretty normal 3♥ opening bid.

SOUTH, however, has a big hand, and she launches into Blackwood.

When NORTH shows one Ace SOUTH can bid 6♥ with confidence.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♠Q			